TOPIC REPORTS: ACCESS TO SERVICES

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

News, Sep – Oct 2026

ACCESS TO SERVICES · DIGITAL DIVIDES

Algeria · Angola · Benin · Cameroon · Congo · Cote d'Ivoire · Djibouti · Egypt · Equatorial Guinea · Eswatini · Ethiopia · Ghana · Guinea · Kenya · Liberia · Libya · Madagascar · Malawi · Morocco · Namibia · Niger · Nigeria · Rwanda · Senegal · Sierra Leone · South Africa · South Sudan · Tanzania · Uganda · Zambia · Zimbabwe

Algeria

NATIONAL SOCIAL CARD

- **Vers une base de données unifiée : La carte sociale nationale prend forme** — Eco Times DZ, 6 September 2026

  Algeria's High Commission for Digitalisation held the fifth meeting of the working group defining the data and indicators for a national social card on 3 September 2026. President Abdelmadjid Tebboune ordered the card on 21 June with a three-month deadline. It is to combine sectoral data on assistance schemes and individuals to target benefits.

UNIVERSAL-SERVICE TENDER FOR MOBILE COVERAGE OF UNDERSERVED AREAS

- **Algeria Opens Tender to Extend Mobile Coverage to 3,000 Underserved Areas** — Tech Africa News, 9 September 2026

  Algeria's Postal and Electronic Communications Regulatory Authority launched a competitive tender on 7 September to extend mobile wireless coverage to 3,000 sparsely populated areas, under its universal service mandate in Law no. 18-04 of 10 May 2018.

- **Arrêté du 21 Rabie El Aouel 1448 correspondant au 3 septembre 2026 fixant le calendrier d'exécution de la procédure d'adjudication par appel à la concurrence relatif à la fourniture du service universel des communications électroniques pour la couverture, par un réseau public de télécommunications mobiles, des localités à faible densité de population** — Ministère de la Poste et des Télécommunications (Journal officiel n° 66, via ARPCE), 13 September 2026

  Algeria's post and telecommunications minister signed an order on 3 September 2026, published in the Official Journal on 13 September, setting the timetable for the tender to provide mobile coverage to sparsely populated localities under the universal service scheme. The tender was to be launched on 6 September and advertised on 7 September, with 45 days to bid and results due 30 days after bids are opened.

UNIVERSAL-SERVICE MOBILE COVERAGE OF 201 SITES (MOBILIS SPECIFICATION)

- **Arrêté du 4 août 2026 portant approbation du cahier des charges relatif à la fourniture du service universel des communications électroniques pour la couverture par un réseau public de télécommunications mobiles de deux cent un (201) sites, confiée à l'opérateur « ATM Mobilis S.P.A »** — Journal officiel de la République algérienne (Secrétariat général du Gouvernement), 23 September 2026

Algeria's Ministry of Post and Telecommunications approved, by order of 4 August 2026 published in the Official Journal on 23 September 2026, a universal-service specification giving ATM Mobilis the task of providing 4G mobile coverage at 201 sites, funded site by site from the universal-service fund. The regulator ARPCE pays a fixed amount per site on acceptance; late delivery draws a penalty of up to 10%. Per-site amounts are in annexed tables.

Angola

PUBLIC COMPUTER ROOMS AND FREE INTERNET POINTS

- **Projecto Angola Digital ja dispoe de 180 pontos de acesso livre a Internet** — ANGOP, 16 September 2026

  Angola's telecoms minister, Mário Oliveira, said in Benguela on 16 September 2026 that the Angola Digital project, promoted by the communications development fund FADCOM, now has about 180 free public internet access points in 18 of the country's 21 provinces. He said the satellite-based Conecta project is also present in 18 provinces.

IDENTITY-CARD UNIVERSALISATION PLAN

- **Angolan Government issues more than 17 million citizen's identity cards** — Angola Newswire (reporting Angola Press Agency), 24 September 2026

  Angola has issued 17,166,000 national identity cards at home and abroad, the national director of registries, Aristides Marques, said in Luanda on 24 September 2026. Daily production capacity has risen from 12,000 to 60,000 cards, cards are now printed in all 21 provinces, and the target is a card for every registered adult by December 2026. A draft law would make the card the only valid identity document.

Benin

EQUAL-OPPORTUNITY CARD FOR PERSONS WITH DISABILITIES

- **Politique d'identification et d'inclusion: 1 422 cartes d'égalité des chances aux personnes handicapées** — La Nation (Bénin), 23 September 2026

  Benin's identification agency ANIP handed 1,422 equal-opportunity cards for persons with disabilities to the Ministry of Family and Social Action in Cotonou on 18 September 2026. The cards, provided for under a 2017 law, give access to rights in health, education, employment and transport. ANIP issued 4,718 cards in 2024 and 2025 and has about 4,000 applications for 2026.

Cameroon

NATIONAL DISABILITY CARD AND ITS ENTITLEMENTS

- **Bridging Digital Dividends: Safeguarding Disabled Persons Online, Offline** — Cameroon Tribune, 2 September 2026

  Civic Watch and the Club des Jeunes Aveugles Réhabilités du Cameroun held a workshop in Yaoundé on 2 September 2026, with German Embassy support, on protecting disabled people online and offline. Cameroon's Ministry of Social Affairs described national disability cards carrying tax exemptions under the 2026 Finance Law and a 50% higher-education fee waiver. Civic Watch's founder warned of targeted cyberbullying on TikTok and Snapchat.

Congo

IRREGULARITY REPORTING CHANNEL

- **KO FUNDA — Signaler une irrégularité** — Ministère du Contrôle d'État, de la Qualité du Service public et de la Lutte contre les Antivaleurs — République du Congo, 2 September 2026

  The Republic of Congo's Ministry of State Control runs KO FUNDA, an online portal where citizens can report corruption, embezzlement, favouritism, absent officials, poor public service and excessive delays. The ministry says reports are handled confidentially and each is examined before any decision. The page carries no publication date.

WOMEN IN DIGITAL PROGRAMMES

- **Promotion de la femme : des étudiantes formées aux métiers du numérique** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville (ADIAC), 12 September 2026

  Congo-Brazzaville's Women's Advisory Council signed a partnership on 11 September 2026 with Hoz Fablab, a Brazzaville technology training centre, to train selected women students in digital skills for six months. The scholarship programme centres on designing, building and hosting websites.

Cote d'Ivoire

DIGITAL INCLUSION PARTNERSHIP FOR PEOPLE WITH DISABILITIES

- **À Abobo, un partenariat stratégique pour renforcer l'inclusion numérique des personnes handicapées** — Linfodrome, 4 September 2026

  Côte d'Ivoire's coordination of disabled people's associations (CAPH-CI) and Orange Côte d'Ivoire signed a partnership on digital inclusion at Abobo on 4 September 2026. It covers digital skills training for autonomy and employment; a first office-software course has begun at CAPH-CI's refurbished headquarters. The article puts internet use at 40.7%, 52.7% urban against 24.6% rural.

Djibouti

WOMEN TRADERS PROGRAMME ON THE DJIBOUTI CORRIDOR

- **From export readiness to market access: EU-backed support strengthens women's participation in trade along the Djibouti-Ethiopia Corridor** — Horn Economic Review, 3 September 2026 ETHIOPIA

  Forty Ethiopian women traders and exporters attended an export-readiness workshop in Bishoftu on 30-31 July 2026 under the €32 million Djibouti Corridor programme, financed by the EU through Global Gateway, delegated to the Agence Française de Développement and run by TradeMark Africa. The programme also funds digital trade systems such as electronic phytosanitary certification.

Egypt

POST-DISTRIBUTION MONITORING OF REFUGEE CASH ASSISTANCE

- **Year-End Post-Distribution Monitoring Report of UNHCR's Multi-Purpose Cash Assistance to Refugees in Egypt** — UNHCR Egypt, 28 February 2025

  UNHCR gave multipurpose cash to an average of 24,335 refugee and asylum-seeker households in Egypt during 2024, paid every two months through Egypt Post offices, and raised transfer values by about 32% over the year. Its December survey reached 393 households, and 99% said the cash let them buy items or services they could not afford before.

Equatorial Guinea

REFUGEE LEGAL FRAMEWORK

- **Equatorial Guinea | Rights Mapping and Analysis Platform** — United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR), Rights Mapping and Analysis Platform, 2 September 2026

  UNHCR's rights-mapping platform records that Equatorial Guinea is party to the 1951 Refugee Convention, its 1967 Protocol and the 1969 OAU Convention but has no domestic law for refugee status determination, so asylum seekers have no formal procedure to apply. It acceded to the Kampala Convention on displaced persons in 2019 and lists five asylum seekers.

Eswatini

BIKA PUBLIC TRANSPORT REPORTING PLATFORM

- **GOVT ROLLS-OUT BIKA PLATFORM TO COMBAT CORRUPTION, ABUSE ON PUBLIC TRANSPORT IN REAL-TIME** — Eswatini Positive News, 21 September 2026

  Eswatini's government has launched BIKA, a real-time platform for the public to report corruption, abuse and unsafe practice on public and freight transport. It is run by the transport ministry with the road transport council, police, emergency services and the Anti-Corruption Commission; reports can be anonymous and are tracked by a reference number.

Ethiopia

OPERATOR FOUNDATION MEMORANDUM ON DISABILITY INCLUSION

- **Safaricom Ethiopia Foundation and FEAPD Sign Three-Year Pact to Advance Disability Inclusion** — Tech Africa News, 1 September 2026

  Safaricom Ethiopia Foundation and the Federation of Ethiopian Associations of Persons with Disabilities signed a three-year memorandum of understanding, reported on 1 September 2026, covering digital inclusion, accessible technology, education, economic empowerment, healthcare and disability-rights advocacy. No funding amount is given.

SMARTPHONE AFFORDABILITY FINANCING

- **Ethio Telecom Secures 15bln Birr Siinqee Bank Deal To Fund Smartphone Access Drive** — Birr Metrics, 3 September 2026

  Ethio Telecom secured a 15 billion birr financing agreement with Siinqee Bank, with 4 billion birr earmarked to help low-income customers buy smartphones. The state operator puts smartphone penetration at about 36% and aims to distribute 2.6 million devices in the next fiscal year. The article does not say when the agreement was signed.

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REFUGEE WOMEN'S SIM REGISTRATION AND MOBILE USE

- **Closing the digital divide for refugee women means understanding their full experience of connectivity** — GSMA Mobile for Humanitarian Innovation (Zainab Moallin), 10 September 2026 UGANDA TANZANIA MAURITANIA GLOBAL

  The GSMA published research on 10 September 2026 on refugee women's mobile use, drawing on fieldwork with Venezuelan refugees in Colombia and in Mauritania's Mbera camp. It reports that refugee women in Ethiopia are twice as likely to have SIMs registered in someone else's name, that in Uganda about a quarter use the internet against half of men, and that in Tanzania identity rules push women to register SIMs through intermediaries.

OMBUDSMAN ONLINE COMPLAINT AND INFORMATION-REQUEST PORTAL

- **Ethiopian Institution of the Ombudsman** — Ethiopian Institution of the Ombudsman, 17 October 2026

  The Ethiopian Institution of the Ombudsman's website says it has resolved more than 48,500 complaints of maladministration through 14 regional offices. It also reports 1.5 million public enquiries and a 96.4% compliance rate by institutions; the figures carry no date.

Ghana

DPI INCLUSIVITY SURVEY

- **Global Development Network kicks off deployment of its five-country DPI Inclusivity Survey** — Global Development Network — Inclusive Digital Transformation Hub, 7 September 2026 SIERRA LEONE GLOBAL

  The Global Development Network has begun fieldwork on a five-country DPI Inclusivity Survey covering Sierra Leone and Ghana alongside Chile, Bangladesh and Indonesia, with partner teams at the Institute for Development and the University of Ghana. Running to April and engaging more than 5,000 households, it asks whether digital identity and digital payment systems leave people feeling more economically, socially and politically included, rather than measuring registration and access.

Guinea

DISABILITY CARD DRAWING ON CENSUS DATA

- **RGPH-4 : les données du recensement bientôt mobilisées pour mieux identifier les personnes vivant avec un handicap** — Nimba224, 11 September 2026

  Guinea's National Statistics Institute met officials of the Ministry of Women, Family and Solidarity on 10 September 2026 about using data from the fourth population census to identify people with disabilities, towards a planned disability card. The institute's director-general, Makan Doumbouya, asked staff to assess which data could be used. No timetable is given.

Kenya

CHILDREN EXPOSED TO UNWANTED SEXUAL CONTENT ONLINE

- **When the danger comes through a child's phone: One in five children exposed to sexual content online** — Daily Nation, 5 September 2026

  A UNICEF report finds about one million internet-using Kenyan children aged 12–17, 20.1%, have been exposed to unwanted sexual content online, the third-highest rate of 21 countries surveyed. Most victims knew their abusers, WhatsApp was the platform most used, and about 1% of cases are reported to police.

DIGITAL LEARNING INITIATIVE IN PUBLIC JUNIOR SCHOOLS

- **Kenya Expands Digital Learning Initiative to 10,384 Public Junior Schools** — Tech Africa News, 10 September 2026

  Kenya is extending its digital learning initiative to 10,384 public junior schools, distributing smartboards and laptops, digitising curriculum content and training teachers. It is run by the ICT ministry through its authority, with the education ministry, the curriculum development institute and the teachers' service commission.

Liberia

DECENTRALISED REGULATOR SERVICE CENTRES

- **LTA Begins Decentralizing Its Regulatory And Consumer Protection Services** — News Public Trust, 5 September 2026

  The Liberia Telecommunications Authority opened its first service centre outside Monrovia, in Buchanan, Grand Bassa County, on 4 September 2026, offering regulatory and consumer-protection services locally. Chairman Clarence Massaquoi said the centre will also help community radio stations with compliance and serve as a model for other counties.

FREEDOM OF INFORMATION COMPLIANCE ENFORCEMENT DRIVE

- **IIC, CENTAL Step Up Transparency, Anti-Corruption Drive** — Global News Network Liberia, 6 September 2026

  Liberia's Independent Information Commission and the anti-corruption group CENTAL ran a Freedom of Information Act compliance campaign from 11 August to 2 September 2026 at the national identification registry, the statistics institute LISGIS, LACE and the water corporation. Agencies were told to appoint information officers, set up request review bodies and publish budgets and contracts proactively. Three more agencies were scheduled for 8-10 September.

Libya

RAQIB COMPLAINTS AND REPORTING PLATFORM

- **منصة رقيب للشكاوي والبلاغات** — هيئة الرقابة الإدارية, 3 September 2026

  Libya's administrative oversight authority has a live complaints and reporting platform covering about 750 reportable state bodies. It launched at a Tripoli anti-corruption event in December 2025; no count of reports received or resolved is published.

UNIVERSITY ACCESS TO A FOREIGN DIGITAL LIBRARY

- **British Council signs MoU with Benghazi University allowing access to the Council's Digital Library to 70,000 students** — Libya Herald, 9 September 2026

  The British Council signed a memorandum with the University of Benghazi giving more than 70,000 students access to its Digital Library of over 80,000 resources, the British Embassy announced on 9 September 2026. The university lost much of its library collection during the war. No cost is stated.

Madagascar

FONDS DECIM AFFORDABLE-DEVICE FACILITY

- **Projet « Pilote Laptop » : facilitation de l'accès aux outils numériques** — Newsmada, 8 September 2026

Madagascar's microfinance institution Paositra Finances launched a scheme at Ankatso letting 1,400 master's students at the universities of Antananarivo and Fianarantsoa buy laptops on 12-month credit. Students pay a 20% deposit of about 210,000 ariary, then 75,000 ariary a month. The scheme draws on part of the World Bank-financed DECIM digital and energy connectivity project.

NATIONAL ASSEMBLY ONLINE PUBLIC CONSULTATIONS

- **Consultations Publiques** — Assemblée nationale de Madagascar, 17 October 2026

  Madagascar's National Assembly runs an online portal for public consultations on bills. Past consultations include the 2026 electoral code reform, an environment bill and national budget priorities for 2026.

Malawi

DIGITAL PLANT HEALTH SERVICE

- **Malawian farmers help shape digital plant-health services** — NIBIO (Norwegian Institute of Bioeconomy Research), 4 September 2026

  Farmers, extension workers, agro-dealers and policymakers tested Malawi's digital plant-health service and proposed changes before wider rollout. Its voice platform reaches basic-phone users in Chichewa and other local languages and takes around 30,000 calls a month despite never having been publicly promoted since its June 2025 launch; participants asked for coverage of soil health, fertilisers, irrigation and weather and for changes to visualisations, language and accessibility.

Morocco

DISABILITY DATA AND ACCESS MEASURES

- **Morocco disability rate rises to 8.7% as access gaps persist** — Hespress English, 3 September 2026

  Morocco's third national disability survey puts disability prevalence at 8.7% of the population, up from 6.8% in 2014, according to preliminary results presented in Rabat on 3 September 2026. The survey covered 20,412 households; only 20% of disabled people reported internet access, and their employment rate was 12.7%. Officials said broader detection tools account for part of the increase.

USE OF AND TRUST IN SOCIAL PLATFORMS

- **86% من المغاربة يستخدمون منصات التواصل و'واتساب' في الصدارة** — Assabah, 4 September 2026

  Sonergia's seventh annual social media barometer for Morocco found 86% of the population using social platforms in 2026, five points above 2025. WhatsApp leads at 83%, followed by Facebook at 64%, while TikTok rose eight points to 32%. Only 39% of Moroccans trust news circulating on the platforms outside official media, against 61% who express some distrust.

Namibia

DIGITISATION OF DISABILITY ASSESSMENT AND GRANT ACCESS

- **Grant system goes digital to better serve disabled Namibians** — Namibian Sun, 8 September 2026

  Namibia is putting new guidelines and digital systems behind the medical assessment of persons with disabilities and their access to social grants.

Niger

NIGER DIGITAL DAY SKILLS CARAVAN

- **Diffa : Le Niger Digital Day renforce les competences numeriques des jeunes** — Agence Nigerienne de Presse (ANP), 3 September 2026

  Niger Digital Day, a digital-skills caravan touring Niger's eight regions, ran a two-day training for about sixty young people at the University of Diffa from 3 September 2026. The university's rector opened the session, which covered digital tools, jobs and opportunities, including AI-based tools.

Nigeria

SMARTPHONE OWNERSHIP

- **Nigeria Smartphone Study: A Nationwide Analysis of Smartphone Ownership and Digital Application Usage** — KPMG Nigeria; Orange Group, 1 September 2026

  KPMG Nigeria and Orange Group's smartphone study, published in September 2026 from 13,251 respondents in 12 cities, puts smartphone ownership at 75% in 2025, up from 64% in 2023. Android runs on 96% of smartphones and WhatsApp on 95%; OPay is installed on 69% and PalmPay on 29%, and over a third of mobile subscribers were still on 2G in May 2026.

FINANCIAL INCLUSION

- **How Nigeria can bring 29m adults into financial system — NIMASA director Ani** — The Sun Nigeria, 4 September 2026

  Odunayo Ani, finance director at Nigeria's maritime agency NIMASA, told a Lagos conference that about 28.9 million adults, 26 per cent, remain outside formal finance, citing EFInA's 2023 survey. She named distance, documentation demands, high charges and the digital divide as barriers, and said banking agents rose from 83,560 in 2019 to about 1.92 million in 2024.

- **Access to Financial Services in Nigeria (A2F) 2023 Survey Report** — EFInA (Enhancing Financial Innovation & Access), 18 July 2024

  EFInA's eighth Access to Financial Services in Nigeria survey, based on 26,930 interviews, puts formal financial inclusion at 64% in 2023, against 57% in 2020. The full report was published in July 2024.

- **Report: digital finance usage hits 64%** — The Nation, 17 September 2026

  EFInA's 2026 Access to Financial Services in Nigeria survey, released in Abuja and reported on 17 September 2026, puts use of digital financial services at 64 per cent and financial exclusion at 21 per cent. Mobile money use rose from 12 per cent in 2023 to 38 per cent, while 53 per cent of adults in the poorest wealth quintile remain excluded and 92 per cent of agricultural workers are paid in cash.

- **Nigeria's Financial Inclusion Reaches 79% As EFInA's A2F 2026 Survey Points To Next Challenge** — Independent Newspaper Nigeria, 22 September 2026

  EFInA's ninth Access to Financial Services in Nigeria survey, released on 16 September 2026, found that 79% of adults, about 94.2 million people, use a financial product or service. Formal inclusion reached 73%, above the 70% target of the National Financial Inclusion Strategy. The Central Bank of Nigeria said the focus now shifts to usage, affordability, trust and financial health.

- **Nigeria hits 73% financial inclusion target, but 60.4 million adults remain vulnerable** — Nairametrics, 5 October 2026

The 2026 Access to Financial Services survey by EFInA and Nigeria's statistics bureau found formal financial inclusion at 73% of adults, above the 70% national target, and use of digital financial services at 64.4%, up from 45% in 2023. Only 30.7% of formally included adults are financially healthy, leaving about 60.4 million adults vulnerable. The survey covered 18,679 adults between April and June 2026.

UK DIGITAL ACCESS PROGRAMME COMMUNITY CONNECTIVITY HUBS

- **UK Backs Rural Digital Revolution With Community Hub in Ogun** — ThisDay, 9 September 2026

  A community-owned connectivity hub was inaugurated on 2 September 2026 at Siun in Obafemi Owode, Ogun State, Nigeria, under the UK Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office's Digital Access Programme. It is one of ten community hubs the programme supports in Nigeria, built with local materials and residents' labour. No cost or connection capacity is given.

- **UK Digital Access Programme Launches Community Connectivity Hub in Ogun State** — Nigeria Communications Week, 9 September 2026

  The UK Digital Access Programme inaugurated the Siun Community Self-Built Connectivity Hub in Obafemi Owode, Ogun State. It is one of ten community-centred hubs the programme supports in Nigeria on a model that places ownership and management with local communities and pairs affordable access with digital skills; how many of the ten are open is not stated.

- **Eze Eberechukwu Oji Commissions Amuvi Community Self-Built Connectivity Hub** — News Leverage, 27 September 2026

  A community connectivity hub sponsored by the UK Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office and run by the Initiative for Digital Inclusion was commissioned at Amuvi, Arochukwu, in Nigeria's Abia State. It offers free internet access and free eight-week training for 100 people in digital marketing, online management and personal digital security. No cost or commissioning date is given.

OPERATOR FOUNDATION AND UNICEF SCHOOL CONNECTIVITY PROGRAMME

- **Airtel Africa Foundation and UNICEF Connect Over 1,200 Nigerian Schools to Digital Learning** — Tech Africa News, 10 September 2026

  An operator's foundation and a United Nations children's agency say they have connected more than 1,200 Nigerian schools to digital learning. The foundation said working with local governments helped it identify the schools that stand to gain most, and cites a Lagos primary school where pupils use the tools and connectivity provided.

ZERO-RATED ACCESS TO EDUCATION PLATFORMS

- **FG scraps data charges for students** — Vanguard, 10 September 2026

  Nigeria's federal government unveiled an initiative for zero-rated access to educational platforms and content, letting students reach approved platforms without paying for internet data. The education minister presented it as removing one of the largest barriers to technology-driven learning; the government also signalled moves to regulate internet access for under-16s.

- **NCC launches zero-rated access to educational platforms** — NewsTimes Nigeria, 10 September 2026

  Nigeria's communications commission launched zero-rated data access to approved educational platforms in Abuja on 10 September 2026, starting on 1 October. Education minister Tunji Alausa said about five million students will get 100 MB of free data a day, worth about N180 billion a year; more than 240,000 schools are geomapped in the education management information system.

- **Reactions as FG plans daily free data for Nigerian students** — The Point, 11 September 2026

  Nigeria's education minister, Tunji Alausa, said students in public senior secondary schools and tertiary institutions will receive 100MB of free daily data for approved educational platforms from 1 October 2026. The Nigerian Communications Commission runs the scheme with MTN, Airtel and Globacom; the ministry and the commission jointly approve platforms, which must meet data-protection and net-neutrality requirements.

- **NCC Launches Zero-Rated Data Initiative for Educational Platforms** — Tech Africa News, 1 October 2026

  Nigeria's communications regulator and the operators' association launched zero-rated access to approved educational platforms, giving eligible learners up to 100MB of free data a day. The association put the industry's commitment at almost N200 billion for an initial pilot of 5,000 learners.

ACCESSIBILITY OF PUBLIC DIGITAL PLATFORMS

- **Nigerian govt platforms fail access test** — ITWeb Africa, 16 September 2026

  An assessment presented to Nigeria's IT development agency found only 47% of about 30 government digital platforms met an accessibility threshold, with failures also on banking and payment platforms. The agency said it has written accessibility into revised website guidelines and is considering national standards.

- **NITDA Moves to Strengthen Digital Accessibility for Nigerians With Disabilities** — Tech Africa News, 16 September 2026

  Nigeria's IT development agency said it will work with the Centre for Inclusive Development on digital accessibility after the group presented research on barriers facing people with disabilities. The agency tied the work to its target of 70% digital literacy by 2027.

NIGERIA LEARNING PASSPORT

- **UNICEF targets wider digital learning access as Oyo adopts Nigeria learning passport** — Vanguard, 17 September 2026

  UNICEF launched the Nigeria Learning Passport in Oyo State on 16 September 2026, the 26th state to adopt the digital learning platform. About 2.4 million children and teachers use it nationwide for curriculum lessons in mathematics, English and science, online or offline, with Airtel covering data costs. UNICEF asked the state to train its 5,000 newly recruited teachers to use it.

TIKTOK ACCESS IN KADUNA, KEBBI, KANO AND SOKOTO

- **Joint Statement on the Unexplained TikTok Disruption in Northern Nigeria by Civil Society Organisations** — Paradigm Initiative, 2 October 2026

  Nigerian civil society groups including Paradigm Initiative, Media Rights Agenda, CJID and Accountability Lab said on 2 October 2026 that TikTok access in Kaduna, Kebbi, Kano and Sokoto had been disrupted since about 14 September, with no public explanation. They asked the Nigerian Communications Commission and other agencies to investigate and publish findings, to disclose any government directive and its legal basis, and to allow independent network testing.

- **Foundation sues as TikTok restricts access to Kano, Kebbi, others** — Punch Newspapers, 6 October 2026

  The Foundation for Digital Justice filed a fundamental-rights suit against TikTok at the Federal High Court in Abuja on 5 October. It alleges that users in Kaduna, Kano, Kebbi and Sokoto states have been restricted since mid-September while the rest of Nigeria keeps full access, and asks for an order restoring it.

- **TikTok sued over Nigeria blackout** — ITWeb Africa, 6 October 2026

A second report of the suit over TikTok access in four northern Nigerian states, summarised above, frames it as a test of platform accountability and digital rights.

Rwanda

BUSINESS OBSTACLES ALERT PLATFORM

- **RDB mulls new platform for businesses to report service delivery obstacles** — The New Times, 8 October 2026

  The Rwanda Development Board said on 8 October 2026 it is preparing a Business Obstacles Alert platform for businesses to report and track obstacles in accessing public services after registration. It said 95% of more than 250,000 services processed since January 2026 met their standard timelines. No launch date is given.

Senegal

ASYLUM APPLICATION AND DOCUMENTATION ROUTE

- **Demande d'asile au Sénégal** — UNHCR Sénégal, 3 September 2026

  The UN refugee agency's Senegal office describes how to claim asylum: applications go to the National Eligibility Commission (CNE) in Dakar with a form, a signed request and four photographs. Applicants receive a renewable six-month receipt allowing free movement while the claim is decided, followed by two interviews. Refusals can be appealed. The page is undated.

INFORMATION SYSTEM FOR MONITORING AND HANDLING CITIZENS' CONCERNS

- **Le communiqué du Conseil des ministres du jeudi 10 septembre 2026** — Agence de Presse Sénégalaise, 10 September 2026

  Senegal's Council of Ministers on 10 September 2026 instructed the state digital company Sénégal Numérique SA, under the Prime Minister's office, to set up a national system for gathering and handling citizens' concerns, fed by ministries, local authorities and dialogue mechanisms. The meeting also set 15 September for the 2026 supplementary finance bill and 30 September for the 2027 finance bill.

UN ÉTUDIANT, UN ORDINATEUR STUDENT-COMPUTER PROGRAMME

- **"Un étudiant, un ordinateur " : Mame Penda Ba ouvre le bal d'une enquête aux multiples interrogations - Camou Communication** — Camou Communication, 8 October 2026

  Senegal's parliamentary commission of inquiry into the One Student, One Computer laptop programme opened hearings on 5 October 2026. A former higher-education funding director testified that she found a recorded order for 25,000 computers from two suppliers without the contracts and referred it to the procurement regulator, ARCOP, in September 2025; ARCOP presented its review of two contracts signed in April 2025.

Sierra Leone

DPI INCLUSIVITY SURVEY

- **Global Development Network kicks off deployment of its five-country DPI Inclusivity Survey** — Global Development Network — Inclusive Digital Transformation Hub, 7 September 2026 GHANA GLOBAL

The Global Development Network has begun fieldwork on a five-country DPI Inclusivity Survey covering Sierra Leone and Ghana alongside Chile, Bangladesh and Indonesia, with partner teams at the Institute for Development and the University of Ghana. Running to April and engaging more than 5,000 households, it asks whether digital identity and digital payment systems leave people feeling more economically, socially and politically included, rather than measuring registration and access.

IDENTITY REGISTRATION OF PERSONS IN CORRECTIONAL CUSTODY

- **NCRA Marks International Identity Day with Registration Drive for 100 Inmates** — The Calabash Newspaper, 18 September 2026

  Sierra Leone's National Civil Registration Authority registered 100 inmates from three Freetown correctional centres for National Identification Numbers on 17 September 2026, International Identity Day. The inmates will receive ID cards free, with the government meeting the cost. The Correctional Service said the exercise builds on inmate biometric registration pilots in 2018 and 2020.

South Africa

INTERNET PRICES AGAINST HEADLINE INFLATION

- **Cost of Living Report — August 2026** — Competition Commission of South Africa, 1 September 2026

  South Africa's Competition Commission published its August 2026 cost-of-living report, tracking prices of food, water, electricity, transport, internet and other essentials for the lowest-income households. Between January and July 2026, wired internet prices rose 3.5% and wireless 4.1%, against headline inflation of 3.8%; the internet figures cover fixed services only, not mobile data.

- **SA's internet costs climb, but other bills rise faster** — ITWeb, 7 September 2026

  Wired internet prices rose 3.5% and wireless 4.1% over the first half of 2026, both ahead of cumulative headline inflation of 3.8%, on the competition authority's cost-of-living report. Over the six years to July 2026 the two rose 18.6% and 6.4% against headline inflation of 36%, so the recent move reverses the longer pattern for a service the authority treats as essential.

MONEY SMART WEEK

- **Digital finance growth puts spotlight on consumer education** — ITWeb, 1 September 2026

  South Africa ran Money Smart Week from 24 to 30 August, an initiative of the committee the Treasury and the conduct authority established to co-ordinate financial literacy, as digital finance growth widens the consumer-protection question.

REGULATOR MARKET INQUIRY INTO THE AFFORDABILITY OF TELECOMMUNICATIONS SERVICES

- **Notice of intention to conduct market inquiry into the affordability of telecommunications services in South Africa - Notice 4130 of 2026** — Independent Communications Authority of South Africa (Government Gazette No. 55299), 4 September 2026

  South Africa's communications regulator ICASA gazetted Notice 4130 of 2026 on 4 September, announcing a market inquiry under section 4B of the ICASA Act into the affordability of voice and broadband for low-income households, rural communities, youth and informal workers. It will assess cost drivers and possible interventions, with a summary of findings due within 90 days of the inquiry's end.

SASSA GRANT REVIEWS

- **Digital Profiteers (Part 3): How combating fraud in SA's digitalised grants system hurts the poor** — Daily Maverick (Open Secrets), 4 September 2026

  Open Secrets published the final part of an investigation into South Africa's digitalised grants system, arguing anti-fraud effort falls on beneficiaries rather than on the private actors deducting from their grants. SASSA flagged more than 420,000 beneficiaries for review in 2025/26 claiming R1 billion saved and targets up to 350,000 in 2026/27 for R1.5 billion; the piece documents a pensioner losing R205 a month to a funeral policy he never consented to.

- **Weaknesses in Sassa payment system triggers portfolio committee concern after qualified audit | Alex News** — Alex News, 8 October 2026

  South Africa's Department of Social Development received a qualified audit opinion for 2025/26 because of weaknesses in the South African Social Security Agency's payment system, including grants paid to deceased people and government employees, Parliament's social development committee heard from the Auditor-General on 6 October 2026. Committee chair Bridget Masango called for tighter verification and controls.

- **SASSA steps up grant controls** — SAnews, 9 October 2026

  The South African Social Security Agency defended its intensified grant reviews, eLife proof-of-life certification and beneficiary biometric enrolment as fraud controls on 9 October 2026. It rejected claims that they exclude eligible people, after media reports of 2025/26 payments to ineligible recipients and a parliamentary committee hearing on 7 October.

PARLIMETER PARLIAMENTARY MONITORING PLATFORM

- **ParliMeter enters its next chapter** — MyZA, 9 September 2026

  South Africa's Parliamentary Monitoring Group took over ParliMeter, a platform tracking MP attendance, bills, committee meetings and questions to ministers, as its EU co-funded phase closed on 9 September 2026. The platform was built by the Organisation Undoing Tax Abuse, the Parliamentary Monitoring Group and OpenUp; a Cape Town event marked the handover.

PRESIDENTIAL HOTLINE

- **Mohai conducts oversight visit to Presidential Hotline Call Centre** — SAnews, 9 September 2026

  South Africa's deputy minister for planning, monitoring and evaluation, Seiso Mohai, made an oversight visit on 9 September 2026 to the Presidential Hotline call centre run by the State Information Technology Agency (SITA) in Centurion. The visit reviewed the case-management technology, escalation and resolution tracking, and scope for automation. The hotline has operated since September 2009.

MOBILE SPECIALIST REFERRAL PLATFORM, PATIENTS REFERRED

- **Afrique du Sud : la plateforme Vula franchit le cap des 3 millions de patients** — wearetech.africa, 15 September 2026

  South African referral app Vula Mobile, which connects rural health workers with specialist doctors, has passed three million patients referred. It operates in five southern African countries, which the report does not name.

SITA PERFORMANCE

- **New Sita boss vows to rebuild trust after governance failures** — Business Day, 21 September 2026

An interview with Magatho Mello, managing director of South Africa's State Information Technology Agency since April and its first permanent head since late 2023. He wants to retire old systems, build shared platforms that serve several departments, and simplify tendering for start-ups. A ministerial report in July had set out governance and procurement failures at the agency over 2020–25.

- **SITA in recovery mode, says comms minister** — ITWeb South Africa, 22 September 2026

  Communications minister Solly Malatsi told GovTech 2026 in Durban that the State IT Agency is recovering under stable leadership and must now deliver on digitising government services and ending fragmented systems. The conference ran under the theme of South African digital sovereignty.

South Sudan

INTERNET SUBSCRIPTION TARIFFS

- **Opinion| Internet tariffs: Has Ateny Wek failed, or joined in eating? - Radio Tamazuj** — Radio Tamazuj, 2 September 2026

  In an opinion column, a member of South Sudan's SPLM-IO political bureau says MTN and Zain raised internet tariffs by about 15%. He asks the information and communications minister, Ateny Wek Ateny, to explain who approved the increase and whether the ministry regulates tariffs.

Tanzania

THIRD NATIONAL FINANCIAL INCLUSION FRAMEWORK

- **From Access to Impact: What Tanzania's NFIF3 Mid-Term Evaluation Really Shows** — TICGL / Tanzania Economic Research Institute, 1 September 2026

  The Tanzania Economic Research Institute, TICGL's research arm, analysed the Bank of Tanzania's mid-term evaluation of the Third National Financial Inclusion Framework (2023–2028), covering December 2023 to December 2025. Access points grew 60.7% to 2,266,706 and active account use rose from 60% to 72.5% of adults. The institute finds service quality and household financial health improving more slowly.

SIM REGISTRATION IDENTITY REQUIREMENT AS APPLIED TO REFUGEES

- **Closing the digital divide for refugee women means understanding their full experience of connectivity** — GSMA Mobile for Humanitarian Innovation (Zainab Moallin), 10 September 2026 ETHIOPIA UGANDA MAURITANIA GLOBAL

  The GSMA published research on 10 September 2026 on refugee women's mobile use, drawing on fieldwork with Venezuelan refugees in Colombia and in Mauritania's Mbera camp. It reports that refugee women in Ethiopia are twice as likely to have SIMs registered in someone else's name, that in Uganda about a quarter use the internet against half of men, and that in Tanzania identity rules push women to register SIMs through intermediaries.

- **Digital inclusion for refugee women must go beyond connectivity: GSMA** — Biometric Update, 14 September 2026 ETHIOPIA UGANDA GLOBAL

  GSMA research finds identity rules for SIM registration push refugee women in Ethiopia and Tanzania to register lines in others' names, limiting control of mobile money and communication. In Uganda about 25% of refugee women use the internet against 50% of men.

REGULATOR'S ASSISTIVE-TECHNOLOGY ACCESSIBILITY INITIATIVE

- **TCRA advances digital inclusion for PwDs through assistive technologies - Daily News** — Daily News (Tanzania), 9 October 2026

  Tanzania's communications regulator (TCRA) said its project to adopt assistive technologies for people with disabilities is 80% complete, at a peer exchange of African regulators in Nairobi from 5 to 9 October 2026 under the iPRIS programme. TCRA's website accessibility work was recognised by the Tanzania Bureau of Standards under a new ICT accessibility standard.

Uganda

REFUGEE INTERNET USE BY GENDER

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SMART VILLAGES PILOT

- **Buhadyo Primary School Smart Classroom Enhancing E-Learning in Butaleja District** — Ministry of ICT and National Guidance, Uganda, 23 September 2026

  Uganda's ICT ministry said a smart classroom at Buhadyo Primary School in Butaleja District, built with Huawei under the Smart Villages pilot, lets pupils join the same e-learning lessons as Nakasero Primary School in Kampala. The pilot adds a telecoms tower and a 120-panel solar system that also powers 25 households. No cost is given.

Zambia

ENTRY-LEVEL HOME FIBRE PRICE

- **Liquid Zambia cuts fibre entry price to K300 and increases speeds** — Efficacy News, 16 September 2026

  Liquid Intelligent Technologies Zambia cut its entry home fibre package to K300 a month for up to 6 Mbps and raised speeds on its other plans at unchanged prices. The company puts Zambian internet penetration at 33% without giving a source.

MYZAMTEL SUPER APP AND KONGOLA MALAITI FINANCIAL SERVICE

- **Zamtel unveils MyZamtel Super App and two Zambia-first digital innovations** — Tech Review Africa, 5 October 2026

  Zambia's Zamtel launched a self-care application with a build-your-own-bundle option, and Kongola Malaiti, a digital financial service reached by short code. No user figures are given.

Zimbabwe

DIGITAL SKILLS TRAINING FOR PERSONS WITH DISABILITIES

- **Zimbabwe expands ICT skills support for teachers with visual impairments** — Digital Watch Observatory, 3 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's telecoms regulator, POTRAZ, held a five-day ICT skills workshop in Chiredzi for 37 teachers with visual impairments, their assistants and aides from all ten provinces. The Internet Society Zimbabwe Chapter ran the training, which covered assistive technologies and accessible digital platforms.

INTERNET AND DATA TRAFFIC

- **Zimbabwe's internet traffic jumps 57%** — ITWeb Africa, 4 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's internet and data traffic rose 57.28% in the first quarter of 2026, the regulator reported, attributing it to faster LTE and 5G deployment, rising smartphone adoption and data-hungry applications. Operators added 13 5G base stations in the quarter to reach 379, covering 18.94% of the population, and deployed 161 further LTE sites; mobile internet and data was the largest revenue contributor at 46.34% of quarterly operator revenue.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	**2026-10-20**
COMPILED	By Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/topics/include-access/include-access-monthly-2026-10-20.pdf
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LICENCE	CC BY 4.0